

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW: PLANNING & PLAYBOOK DOCUMENTS

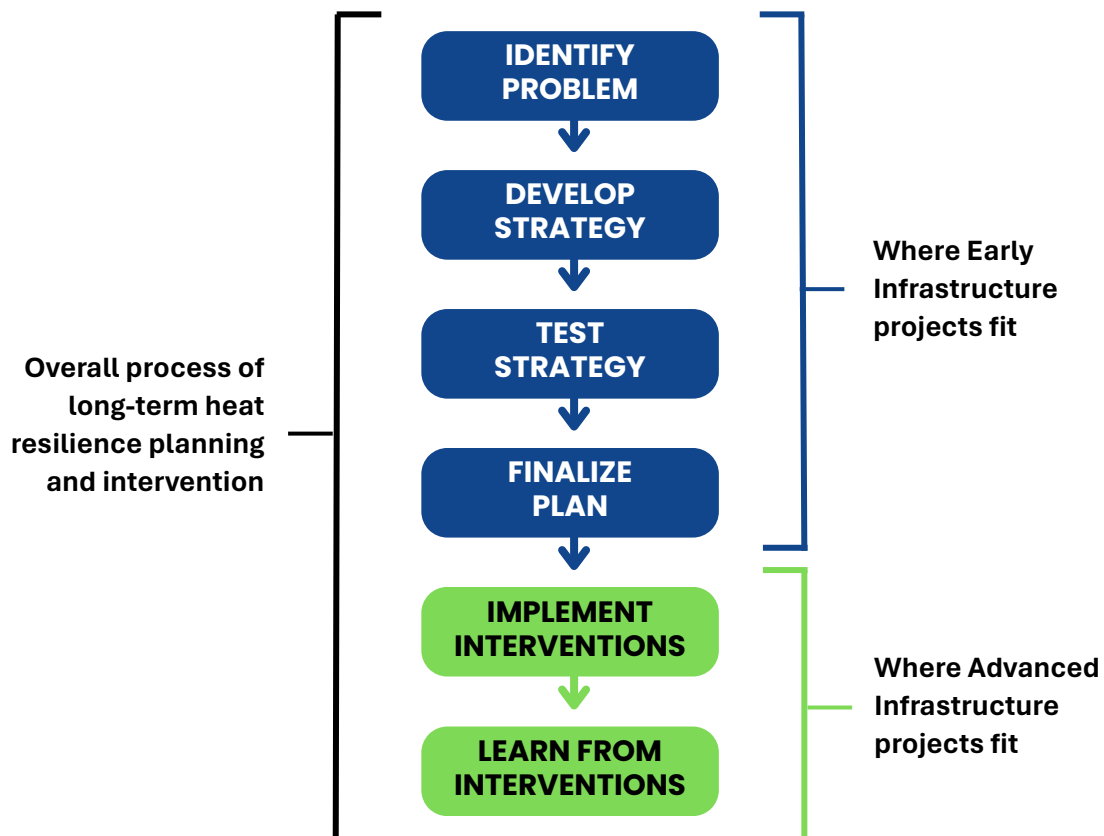
Background

Round 2 of The Extreme Heat and Community Resilience Program will fund Early and Advanced Infrastructure projects to mitigate the impacts of extreme heat. **Each project type requires the production of a document along with the implemented infrastructure: a Planning Document for Early Infrastructure and a Future Implementation Playbook for Advanced Infrastructure.**

Why are these documents required?

The required documents create a bridge between the proposed projects and future efforts. They are how you promote and plan for lasting benefits in your community. The Early Infrastructure Planning Document should 1) establish a foundation for **what** interventions the community needs and 2) provide a long-term practical pathway for **how** you will implement these interventions, turning lessons learned from the demonstration project into concrete steps toward future heat resilience. The Advanced Infrastructure Future Implementation Playbook should 1) **capture findings** from an infrastructure project that you implemented as a result of previous planning efforts and 2) **provide a clear guide** for how the the community can continue heat resilience work.

The graphic below depicts the overall process of comprehensive, long-term heat resilience planning and shows where each project type fits within the process.



Thinking about the Early Infrastructure Planning Document

IDENTIFY PROBLEM

Define how and where extreme heat is causing harm in the area.

DEVELOP STRATEGY

Collect data & community input to form a draft Heat Action Plan or Infrastructure Master Plan that provides guidance for how to address the problem over the next 10+ years.

TEST STRATEGY

Test one of the plan's proposed strategies through an infrastructure demonstration. Use the results to tailor the draft plan's strategies and goals.

FINALIZED PLANNING DOCUMENT

Early Infrastructure projects are intended to cover the first part of the long-term heat resilience planning process for communities that have not yet done much heat resilience planning, as depicted to the left. In the case of Early Infrastructure grants, the finalized long-term strategy must take the form of either an **Extreme Heat Action Plan** or an **Infrastructure Master Plan**. Your infrastructure demonstration will serve as your testing of your long-term strategy.

When thinking about the Early Infrastructure grant as a whole, think of the infrastructure demonstration project and the Planning Document as two elements that inform each other: the Planning Document evaluates what needs to be done, the demonstration tests and teaches, and the Planning Document then turns those lessons into a practical path toward future infrastructure.

Your Planning Document will not be developed until after grant award, so a portion of your budget should go towards its development. Your infrastructure demonstration results will then be incorporated back into the document to shape future strategy. However, you do need an initial vision of what you want it to accomplish, how you'll get there, and how you will discuss the document in your Full Application.

Thinking about the Advanced Infrastructure Future Implementation Playbook

Advanced Infrastructure projects are intended to implement interventions that are identified by **pre-existing planning work**, as shown in the green graphic. The Future Implementation Playbook offers significantly more flexibility than the Early Infrastructure Planning Document and may take the form of a policy memo, design guide, set of funding guidelines, or other format that explains how your implemented infrastructure helps and can be expanded upon.

The Playbook will evolve as your project unfolds since it's shaped by what you actually learn along the way, but at the application stage, you still need an initial vision of it. The questions below can help you to conceptualize your Playbook for the Full Application:

- **What?** What do you expect to learn from implementing this project that's worth passing on?
- **Why?** Why do those lessons matter? How will they keep the extreme heat agenda moving, whether by scaling the work or addressing a new need it surfaces?
- **Who?** Who is capturing these lessons? Whose experience and perspective does the Playbook reflect?
- **Who for?** Who are you writing it for? Is it for the policymakers, agencies, or organizations who could carry the work forward?

INTERVENTION IDENTIFIED IN PREVIOUS WORK

Implement infrastructure

Identify lessons learned

Use takeaways to inform & support future efforts (Future Implementation Playbook)

Full Application considerations

In order for your Full Application to be considered for funding, it **must** discuss plans to complete the required document. The following steps are recommended during the application development process to develop the scope, scale, budget, and level of anticipated effort for this document:

1. **Review examples** of your required document type to better understand expectations.
 - Early Infrastructure Planning Document examples:
 - [Example 1 - an example of an Infrastructure Master Plan](#)
 - [Example 2 - an example of an Extreme Heat Action Plan](#)
 - [Example 3 - an example of an Extreme Heat Action Plan](#)
 - Advanced Infrastructure Future Implementation Playbook examples:
 - [Example 1 - an example of an Extreme Heat Toolkit](#)
 - [Example 2 - an example of a Policy Guide](#)
 - [Example 3 - an example of an Infrastructure Case Study](#)
2. Using the above examples and the Full Guideline requirements for either [Early Infrastructure](#) or [Advanced Infrastructure](#) documents, decide the **scope** and **topic** of your document.
3. Meet with Co-Applicant(s) and any project partners to discuss the **cost, tasks, and level of effort** anticipated for the production of your required document.
 - Determine who will be responsible for producing the document - will it be a project partner, or will you seek outside help (such as a consulting or planning firm)?
 - What data will you gather to inform the document, and how will you gather it?
 - How will you collect and integrate community input?
 - What are the expected costs associated with producing this document, including external assistance (if applicable)?
4. Integrate decisions from step 3 into your Full Application as tasks or items in your **Workplan** and **Budget**.
5. Make sure that your **project narrative** includes a description of your required document and its relationship to your proposed infrastructure.
6. Consider how to relate your plans for your required document to the **program values**:
 - **Harm Reduction**: How will your infrastructure test what reduces harm, and how will the required document turn those lessons into guidance for future infrastructure?
 - **Belonging**: How will your approach to Belonging in the infrastructure project inform the direction proposed in your required document for future infrastructure?
 - **Lasting Community Benefits**: What is the document intended to accomplish, and how will it lead to expanded infrastructure, local support, and funding pathways after the grant term?

If you have any questions about the required planning document and how to discuss it in your Full Application, plan to attend an open [Office Hours session](#).